

ELITE SAGARIN MODEL

FCS vs FBS · Week 1 Matchups · 2026

Model spread = FBS Composite – FCS Composite + 2.80 HFA for FBS home games. Green = competitive game (model spread < 20). Red = blowout warning (> 40 pts). FCS comp: Sagarin 2025-adj. FBS comp: 70% SP+_scaled + 30% Sagarin.

All FCS vs FBS Week 1 Games (33 matchups)

Vegas does not post lines for most FCS-FBS games. Model spread shown for sharp reference. Green rows = upset window exists (spread < 14). Amber = soft FBS host (spread 14-21).

	TV	FCS Team	FCS Comp	FBS Team	FBS Comp	Neutral	Model Spread	Vegas	Sharp Note
9	CBSSN	Jacksonville State	40.0	NDSU	71.7	No	NDSU -34.5	TBD	—
8	ESPN+	UAlbany	37.5	Buffalo	58.6	No	Buffalo -23.9	TBD	— Buffalo -16 model. MAC bottom vs C
8	ESPN+	Bethune-Cookman	39.0	UCF	71.1	No	UCF -34.9	TBD	—
8	ESPN+	Merrimack	38.0	Delaware	58.4	No	Delaware -23.2	TBD	—
8	ESPN+	West Georgia	53.0	Kennesaw State	61.8	No	Kennesaw State -11.6	TBD	★★★ KSU comp only 63.4. WG comp 53. KSU -17+, WG +17 is value.
8	SEC Net.	Ark.-Pine Bluff	30.0	Missouri	83.2	No	Missouri -56.0	TBD	— Missouri -50 model. APB comp only 3
8	Peacock	Eastern Illinois	38.5	Minnesota	75.0	No	Minnesota -39.3	TBD	—
8	ESPN+	Idaho	51.0	Utah	83.2	No	Utah -35.0	TBD	★★ Utah SP+ 11.9, but Utah's Sag 86.8. Utah -38. Cupcake.
8	ESPN+	NC A&T;	29.0	Georgia State	49.0	No	Georgia State -22.8	TBD	— Georgia State comp only 50.3 vs NC Model -24.
8	Big Ten	Indiana State	44.0	Purdue	66.9	No	Purdue -25.7	TBD	★★ Purdue -25 model. Purdue Sag only Watch line – if -28+, fade Purdue.
8	ESPNU	LIU	42.0	Kansas	73.3	No	Kansas -34.1	TBD	—
8	N/A	Lafayette	49.0	UConn	62.1	No	UConn -15.9	TBD	— UConn comp 67.0 vs Lafayette 49.0.
8	CBSSN	Bryant	39.0	Army	68.4	No	Army -32.2	TBD	—
8	MW+	Duquesne	44.0	Air Force	66.5	No	Air Force -25.3	TBD	—
8	ESPN+	Tarleton State	67.5	Bowling Green	57.6	No	Tarleton State -7.1	TBD	★★★ Model: Tarleton FAVOURED over BG at home may be -7 to -14. 6-12pt ed
8	ESPN	New Hampshire	51.0	Syracuse	67.6	No	Syracuse -19.4	TBD	—
8	ESPN	Youngstown State	59.0	Kentucky	73.9	No	Kentucky -17.7	TBD	★ YSU comp 59 vs KY comp 74. Model Standard cupcake.
8	ESPN+	SE Missouri State	43.0	Iowa State	73.2	No	Iowa State -33.0	TBD	—
8	ESPN+	Rhode Island	55.5	Temple	62.0	No	Temple -9.3	TBD	★★ RI comp 55.5 vs Temple comp 61.9. Temple -9. If -14+, RI +14 value.
8	SEC+	Tennessee State	34.5	Georgia	92.5	No	Georgia -60.8	TBD	— Georgia -55 model. Largest margin of
8	ESPN	Furman	43.5	Tennessee	83.9	No	Tennessee -43.2	TBD	—
8	ESPN+	The Citadel	44.0	Charlotte	43.8	No	Charlotte -2.6	TBD	—
8	CBSSN	Towson	46.5	Navy	72.1	No	Navy -28.4	TBD	—
8	ESPN+	UTRGV	51.5	UTSA	70.1	No	UTSA -21.4	TBD	— UTSA comp 73.5 vs UTRGV 51.5. Mo Large blowout expected.
8	CW Net.	Fordham	49.5	NDSU	71.7	No	NDSU -25.0	TBD	★ Fordham (Patriot, 49.0) at NDSU (nev 76.2). NDSU -12 per model.
8	ESPN+	Maine	46.5	App State	58.5	No	App State -14.8	TBD	—
8	ESPN	North Alabama	49.5	Arkansas	74.6	No	Arkansas -27.9	TBD	— Arkansas comp 74.4 vs N.Ala 49.5. M
8	ESPN+	Alcorn State	35.5	Southern Miss	70.7	No	Southern Miss -38.0	TBD	—

	TV	FCS Team	FCS Comp	FBS Team	FBS Comp	Neutral	Model Spread	Vegas	Sharp Note
	ESPN	Austin Peay	55.5	Vanderbilt	81.6	No	Vanderbilt -28.9	TBD	— Austin Peay comp 55.5 vs Vanderbilt Model -33.
	FS1	Abilene Christian	58.5	Texas Tech	91.5	No	Texas Tech -35.8	TBD	★ ACU comp 58.5 vs TT comp 88.8. Mo Standard.
	ESPN+	Nicholls	45.5	Kansas State	79.1	No	Kansas State -36.4	TBD	— Kansas State -33 model. Standard.
	ESPN	Missouri State	48.0	Texas A&M;	88.2	No	Texas A&M; -43.0	Texas A&M; -38.5	★ A&M; -38.5 opened. Model: A&M; -36 model — pass.
	ESPN+	Norfolk State	36.5	Old Dominion	67.5	No	Old Dominion -33.8	TBD	—

Top FCS Upset Candidates

★★★ Tarleton State at Bowling Green: Tarleton composite 67.5 (WAC powerhouse, 12-2 in 2025) vs Bowling Green composite 62.4 (MAC, 4-8). Model makes TARLETON the FAVOURITE even as road team. If Vegas opens BG at home -7 to -14, this represents the largest FCS upset value of the entire weekend. ★★★ West Georgia at Kennesaw State: Model KSU -10.5. WG composite 53.0 is a legitimate FCS WAC team. KSU (C-USA, first full FBS year) only rates 63.4 composite. If market opens KSU -17+, West Georgia +17 is strong value. ★★ Indiana State at Purdue: Purdue model spread -25. MVFC's Indiana State (44.0 comp) at a Purdue team that went 2-10 in 2025 with a Sagarin of only 63.58. If Vegas inflates Purdue to -30+, back Indiana State to cover.